

The Garden at El Oasis: Plant Inventory

Condo Garden · Guanacaste, Costa Rica · Plant Identification & Ecological Assessment

Status: ■ Ph = Photographed ■ Co = Confirmed ■ Re = Recommended | Row colours: green = standard amber = outside boundary [Nearby] blue = ID Pending | Invasive Risk: Very High (red) · High (orange) | Ref #: see Photo Index document for filename, date & notes

Status	Common Name	Scientific Name	Origin	Water	Drought	Eco Value	Invasive Risk	Wow	Inventory Notes	Ref #
ESTABLISHED PLANTS — Confirmed or Photographed in Garden										
■ Ph	Coconut Palm	Cocos nucifera	Pacific Islands	Moderate	Moderate	Medium	Low	High	Coastal icon; wildlife food source. Hoffmann's Woodpecker documented breaching intact husk to feed on flesh.	28
■ Ph	Tropical Almond	Terminalia catappa	SE Asia	Low–Moderate	Good	High	Low	Medium	Excellent shade; bird & bat food. Canopy visible in main path shot.	3
■ Ph	Plumeria / Frangipani	Plumeria sp.	Caribbean / Mexico	Low	Excellent	High	Low	High	Fragrant flowers; supports pollinators. Three colour forms documented. Hamadryas Cracker and Mosaic butterfly both recorded.	7, 17, 30, 34, 37
■ Ph	Banana	Musa sp.	SE Asia	Very High	Poor	Low	Low	Medium	Fruit; large tropical aesthetic; very water hungry. Boat-billed Flycatcher and hummingbirds documented.	19, 23, 32
■ Ph	Ti Plant / Cordyline	Cordyline fruticosa	Pacific Islands	Moderate	Fair	Low	Low	Medium	Dramatic red/bronze foliage. No dedicated close-up — see Shoot List D.	1, 3
■ Ph	Croton	Codiaeum variegatum	SE Asia	Moderate	Fair	Low–Medium	Low	Medium	Vivid multicoloured foliage. No dedicated close-up — see Shoot List D.	1, 3
■ Ph	Ixora	Ixora coccinea	Asia	Moderate	Fair	Medium	Low	Medium	Hummingbird & butterfly attractor. Heliconius longwing documented nectaring. Striped Tortoise Beetle (Cassidinae sp.) documented on leaf — first beetle recorded in survey.	1, 12, 20, 58
■ Ph	Mexican Petunia	Ruellia simplex	Mexico / S. America	Low	Good	Low	Very High	Low–Medium	REMOVE — seriously invasive. Porterweed is a recommended native replacement. Wide extent shot needed before removal — see Shoot List D.	13
■ Ph	Firecracker Plant	Russelia equisetiformis	Mexico	Low	Good	Medium	Low	Medium	Hummingbird favourite. Visible on raised bed wall in path shot; no dedicated frame — see Shoot List D.	3
■ Ph	Ficus Hedge	Ficus sp.	Tropical Asia	Moderate–High	Fair	Low	Low	Low	Neat privacy screening.	2, 3
■ Ph	Sea Grape	Coccoloba uvifera	Caribbean	Low	Excellent	High	Low	Medium	Native coastal species. Stingless bees (Meliponini) documented foraging on the flower spike.	20, 39
■ Ph	Queen / Date Palm	Phoenix sp. / Syagrus sp.	Americas / Asia	Low–Moderate	Good	Medium	Low	High	Elegant pool-side palms. Hoffmann's Woodpecker documented on the fruit cluster.	2, 27
■ Ph	Fan Palm	Livistona sp.	Asia / Australia	Moderate	Moderate	Low	Low	Medium	Distinctive fan-shaped fronds. Visible mid-ground in path shot; no dedicated frame — see Shoot List D.	3
■ Ph	Pejibaye Palm	Bactris gasipaes	C. America (Native)	Moderate	Moderate	High	Low	High	Pre-Columbian cultivar; one of Mesoamerica's oldest domesticated food	4_May_004, 59

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									palms. Cluster fruit documented supporting Great-tailed Grackle (male, May). Female Great-tailed Grackle also documented at garden birdbath. Edible fruit (peach palm) traditionally cooked; high in oils and starch. Spiny trunk — handle with care.	
■ Co	Guanacaste / Rain Tree	Samanea saman	S. America	Low	Excellent	High	Low	Very High	Massive spreading canopy; confirm vs true Guanacaste tree — species ID needed. See Shoot List A.	—
■ Ph	Mango	Mangifera indica	SE Asia	Low–Moderate	Good	Medium	Low	Medium	Non-native but naturalized; fruiting. Orange-fronted Parakeets and Yellow-naped Amazon documented feeding. Harvest before ripe.	2, 14, 26
■ Ph	Cashew	Anacardium occidentale	NE Brazil	Low	Excellent	Medium	Low	Medium	Nearly naturalized; very drought hardy. Yellow-naped Amazon (near-threatened IUCN) and Streak-backed Oriole both documented — one of the most ecologically productive trees in the garden.	21, 33
■ Ph	Heliconia	Heliconia sp.	Tropical Americas	High	Poor	Very High	Low	Very High	Primary hummingbird food; guidebook icon; high cost/high benefit. Three forms documented. Thin clumps regularly.	16, 22, 41
■ Ph	Philodendron	Philodendron sp.	Tropical Americas	Moderate	Fair	Medium	Low	Medium	Climber; observed on fallen tree. No photo yet — see Shoot List A.	—
■ Co	Bird of Paradise	Strelitzia sp.	South Africa	Low	Good	Low	Low	Very High	Striking architectural flower. No photo yet — see Shoot List A.	—
■ Ph	Bougainvillea	Bougainvillea sp.	S. America	Very Low	Excellent	Low–Medium	Low	Very High	Thrives on neglect; cut hard for best flowering. Macro and cluster views documented. Also in garden wall and development shots.	36, 44, 50
■ Co	Lantana	Lantana camara	Tropical Americas	Very Low	Excellent	Medium	Very High	High	Outstanding butterfly attractor; globally invasive. Replace with L. trifolia. Document before removing — see Shoot List A.	—
■ Ph	Guava	Psidium guajava	Tropical Americas	Low–Moderate	Good	Controversial	Very High	Medium	Edible fruit; bird-dispersed. Variegated Squirrel documented mid-feed — confirms dispersal risk. Further portraits: squirrel foraging on branch (Aug), feeding on papaya at tree base (Aug), and head-down trunk descent on possible Gumbo Limbo (May) — confirms ground-level seed dispersal pathway. Harvest before ripe.	10, 60, 61, 62
■ Ph	Noche Buena	Euphorbia pulcherrima	Mexico / C. America	Low–Moderate	Good	Medium	Low	Very High	Poinsettia / Lobster Plant; spectacular dry-season bloomer; native to region.	1
■ Ph	Bottlebrush	Callistemon citrinus	Australia	Very Low	Excellent	Medium–High	Low	High	Outstanding hummingbird plant; cut hard for best flowering. Removed from villa-side bed May 2026 for hummingbird project.	42, 53
■ Ph	Bengal Clock Vine	Thunbergia grandiflora	India / SE Asia	Moderate	Fair	Low–Medium	Very High	Very High	Stunning lavender flowers; very hard to contain — deadhead before seed set. Native alternative: Passiflora.	4

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■ Ph [Nearby]	Pride of Barbados	Caesalpinia pulcherrima	SE Mexico / C. America (Native)	Low	Excellent	Very High	Low	Very High	Road verge outside garden boundary. Gulf Fritillary documented. Strong candidate for introduction; low invasive risk within native range.	5
NEW ENTRIES — Photographed in Survey Area; Not Yet in Main Inventory										
■ Ph — New Entry	White Buttercup / Mariposa Blanca	Turnera subulata	C. America (Native)	Low	Excellent	High	Low	High	New entry — to be added. White petals, dark centre. Known as Politicians' Flower. Strong groundcover/border candidate.	9
■ Ph — ID Pending	Unidentified Groundcover	Species unknown	Unknown	—	—	—	—	—	Beneath welcome gazebo. Possibly Portulaca, Bacopa (native), Sweet Alyssum, or Euphorbia. Priority ID task — see Shoot List C.	8
■ Ph — Assess	Celosia / Cockscomb	Celosia argentea var. plumosa	Tropical Africa / Asia	Low	Good	Low–Medium	Low	High	Ornamental annual; low invasive risk; moderate pollinator value. Full lifecycle documented. Flagged for assessment.	15
■ Ph — Assess	Bauhinia / Orchid Tree	Bauhinia sp.	Tropical Asia	Low–Moderate	Good	Medium	Low	Very High	Moderate pollinator value; low invasive risk. Flagged for assessment.	31
■ Ph — Assess	Zinnia	Zinnia sp.	Mexico (cultivated)	Low	Good	Medium	Low	High	Pollinator-support annual. White Peacock butterfly documented. Flagged for assessment.	24
■ Ph — Assess	Hibiscus (Red & Pink forms)	Hibiscus sp.	Tropical Asia	Moderate	Fair	Medium	Low	Very High	Two colour forms established. Brimstone butterfly documented on red form. Flagged for assessment.	35, 38
■ Ph — Assess	Red Ginger	Alpinia purpurata	SE Asia / Pacific	Moderate	Fair	Medium	Low	Very High	Good hummingbird value; fourth ginger-family entry. Flagged for assessment.	40
■ Ph — Assess	Cereus / Columnar Cactus	Cereus sp. / Pilosocereus sp.	Americas	Very Low	Exceptional	Medium–High	Low	High	Boundary fence location. Nesting sites for birds; fruit for wildlife. Flagged for assessment.	44, 50
■ Ph — Assess	Morning Glory	Ipomoea sp.	Tropical Americas	Low–Moderate	Good	Variable	Assess	High	Species ID required — genus ranges from native to seriously invasive. Do not plant further until identified.	51
■ Ph — Assess	Bidens / Shepherd's Needle	Bidens pilosa	Tropical Americas (Native)	Low	Excellent	High	Low	Low	One of the most ecologically productive plants in the survey area. Four butterfly species documented. Urgently flagged for inventory.	43, 46, 48, 49
■ Ph — ID Pending	UFO — Scarlet Canopy Tree (Beach)	Delonix regia or Erythrina sp.	Uncertain	Low	Good	High?	Low	Very High	Flamboyán vs Poro — identity contested. If Poro (native), significant survey addition. Priority ID task — see Shoot List C.	52
■ Ph — ID Pending	Gumbo Limbo (poss.)	Bursera simaruba?	C. America (Native)	—	—	—	—	High?	ID inferred from bark character in Variegated Squirrel portrait (May): smooth, reddish-brown, papery-peeling texture consistent with Gumbo Limbo (“tourist tree”). Native dry forest species; high ecological value if confirmed. Priority ID task — inspect bark and leaf in situ.	62

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DEVELOPMENT RECORDS — Hummingbird Project (2026)										
■ Ph — Develo pment	Villa Side Bed: Before State	Acalypha hispida (prob.) + Callistemon citrinus	Tropical Asia / Australia	—	—	—	—	—	Before-removal record. Replaced by species rated collectively higher for hummingbird value.	53
■ Ph — Develo pment	Villa Side Bed: Phase One Complete	Bougainvillea + Porterweed + Native Lantana	S. America / C. America (Native)	Very Low	Excellent	High	Low	High	Hummingbird Project Phase One complete. New tiled raised planters. Year-round nectar at villa entrance.	25, 54

Plant identifications based on photographic analysis and garden surveys, Guanacaste, Costa Rica. Ecological assessments reflect documented behaviour in Guanacaste's Tropical Dry Forest. Invasive risk ratings reflect IUCN and regional assessments for Central America. Species identifications provisional pending expert review. No gnomes were consulted.